"IN THE BEGINNING..."

GENESIS 40

IN 5 MINUTES

When:

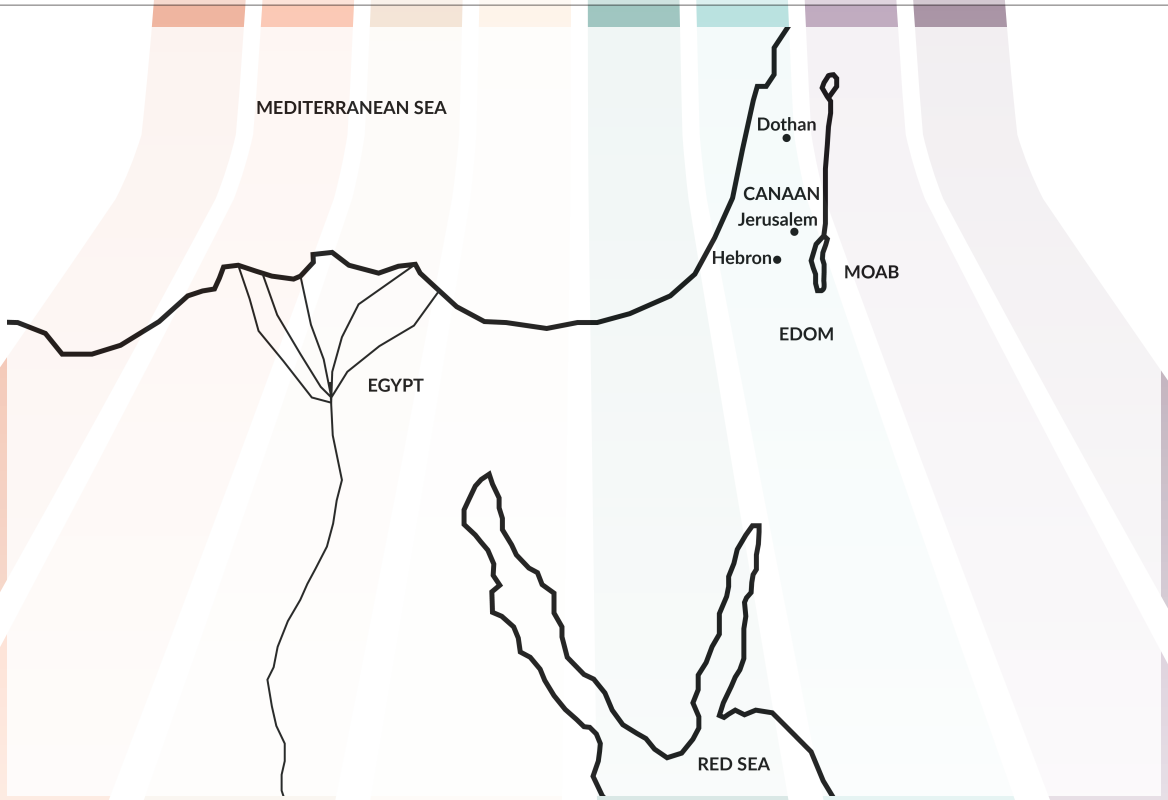
- Joseph was 17 when he went to Egypt (approximately 1728 B.C.).
- He was around 28 years old when he met Pharaoh's cupbearer and baker (41:46).

Characters:

- Joseph – Jacob's son with Rachel. Joseph's brothers hated him and sold him into slavery.
- Pharaoh's Cupbearer and Baker – Officers of Pharaoh who had their dreams interpreted by Joseph while in prison.

Where:

- The story recorded in Genesis 40 took place in the country of Egypt.



Outline:

- PHARAOH'S CUPBEARER AND BAKER (40:1-8):
    + Sometime after Joseph was thrown into prison, the chief cupbearer and chief baker committed an offense against the king of Egypt and were put in prison.
    + The keeper of the prison appointed Joseph to attend to them.
    + One night, they both dreamed dreams and were troubled because they didn't know how to interpret them.
    + Joseph told them God was the interpreter of dreams and he asked them to recount their dreams to him.
- THE CUPBEARER'S DREAM AND ITS INTERPRETATION (40:9-15):
    + The chief cupbearer dreamed about a vine with three branches. The vine bloomed and clusters of grapes grew on it.
    + The cupbearer was standing nearby with Pharaoh's cup in his hand, so he filled it with juice, and gave it to Pharaoh.
    + Joseph gave him the interpretation of the dream.
    + In three days, the cupbearer would be released from prison and reinstated to his role as Pharaoh's cupbearer.
    + Joseph asked the cupbearer to mention him to Pharaoh so he could be let out of prison.
- THE BAKER'S DREAM AND ITS INTERPRETATION (40:16-19):
    + When the baker heard the interpretation of the cupbearer's dream, he was eager for Joseph to interpret his.
    + He told Joseph he dreamed of three cake baskets on his head. In the top basket there were baked goods prepared for Pharaoh, but birds came and started eating the food.
    + Joseph told him the three baskets represented three days.
    + In three days, Pharaoh would hang the baker on a tree and the birds would come to eat his flesh.
- THE FATE OF THE CUPBEARER AND THE BAKER (40:20-23):
    + Three days later, Pharaoh celebrated his birthday with a feast.
    + He summoned the cupbearer and baker from the prison, gave the cupbearer his job back, and hanged the baker.
    + But the chief cupbearer forgot to mention Joseph to Pharaoh, and he remained in prison.

Application:

- Ingratitude is a terrible sin.
- An ungrateful heart is not a godly heart.
- It's hard to believe the cupbearer forgot about Joseph, but have their been times in your life when you forgot about those who helped you during your times of trouble?
- Have you been ungrateful to the people who raised you? Those who have poured so much of their time into you? Those who loved you at your lowest?
- An ungrateful person will never understand the Bible, because an ungrateful person will never appreciate God's greatest gift, Jesus!